IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 06

TEACHERS AND EDUCATION

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- What subject did you like most at school?
- Did you have a favourite teacher?
- Would you like to study abroad?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a teacher you admired.

You should say:

- who the teacher was
- what they taught
- what they were like
- why you admired them

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- What makes a good teacher?
- How has the role of teachers changed with technology?
- Does formal education prepare young people for work?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “teachers and education” card

- A teacher you admired
- A subject you enjoyed at school
- A person who taught you something useful
- A time you learned a new skill
- A school you attended
- An important piece of advice you received
- A course or class you took recently
- A book or lesson that changed the way you think

Who the teacher was → **What** they taught → **What like** qualities and style → **Why** you admired them

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing a great teacher

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 go the extra mile

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘shimcha harakat qilmoq, ustidan ish qilmoq • *to do more than people expect of you*

BAND 8 STORY

My maths teacher **went the extra mile** for us before the national exams. She stayed after school every Thursday to explain tricky problems, and I honestly don’t think I’d have passed without her.

≈ **make an extra effort** — qo‘shimcha kuch sarflamoq

≈ **bend over backwards** — qo‘lidan kelganini qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ustozning fidoyiligini ta’riflashda ishlating: go the extra mile for somebody / to help. Part 2 da ‘why I admired’ qismi uchun juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Our English teacher always **went the extra mile**, even lending us her own books.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 keep students engaged

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘quvchilarning e’tiborini ushlab turmoq • *to make learners stay interested and involved in the lesson*

BAND 8 STORY

Mr Karimov **kept** us **engaged** with short games and real-life examples, so nobody ever stared out of the window. Even the laziest boys in the class were raising their hands by the end of term.

≈ **hold the class’s attention** — sinf e’tiborini ushlab turmoq

≈ **capture students’ imagination** — o‘quvchilar tasavvurini egallamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Fe’l + object + adjective: keep + students + engaged. Part 2 va Part 3 da ‘good teacher’ mavzusida ishlating; ‘interesting‘ o‘rniga yaxshiroq.

Namuna gap: A good teacher knows how to **keep students engaged** for a whole forty-five minutes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 bring a subject to life

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

faniga jon kiritmoq, jonli qilib tushuntirmoq • *to make a topic feel real and exciting instead of boring*

BAND 8 STORY

History was just dates to me until Ms Dilfuza **brought** it **to life** by acting out famous battles. I still remember the whole class laughing, and for the first time I actually wanted to read the textbook.

≈ **make a subject come alive** — fanni jonlantirmoq

≈ **make learning fun** — o‘qishni qiziqarli qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Quruq fanlarni (tarix, adabiyot) tasvirlashda ishlating: bring + noun + to life. Part 2 da ustoz haqida gapirganda chiroyli eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: Her stories **brought** chemistry **to life** for even the shyest students.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 a role model

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

namuna bo‘ladigan inson • *a person whose behaviour others want to copy*

BAND 8 STORY

My school director was **a role model** for the whole mahalla. He arrived first and left last, and he treated the cleaners with the same respect as the inspectors, which taught me more than any lesson.

≈ **a source of inspiration** — ilhom manbai

≈ **an example to follow** — ergashishga arziydigan namuna

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ustoz yoki mashhur odamni maqtashda: be a role model for / to somebody. Part 2 va Part 3 (young people) da juda universal ibora.

Namuna gap: Teachers are **role models** whether they like it or not, because children copy what they see.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 strict but fair

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qattiqqo‘l, lekin adolatli • *firm with rules but treating everyone equally*

BAND 8 STORY

Our physics teacher was **strict but fair**: late homework meant zero, no matter whose son you were. At first we were scared of him, but later we realised that we respected him exactly because he never played favourites.

≈ **firm but kind** — qattiq, lekin mehribon

≈ **no-nonsense** — jiddiy, hazilni yoqtirmaydigan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ustozning xarakterini tasvirlashda ‘strict’ ni yumshatish uchun ishlating. Faqat ‘strict’ desangiz salbiy bo‘lib qoladi, ‘but fair’ qo‘shing.

Namuna gap: I’d choose a teacher who is **strict but fair** over one who is friendly but lazy.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 have a gift for

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga qobiliyati bor, iste’dodli • *to be naturally very good at something*

BAND 8 STORY

Ms Nargiza **had a gift for** explaining difficult grammar in simple words. When she drew a little picture on the board, everything suddenly clicked, and I stopped being afraid of English.

≈ **have a knack for** — ... ning uddasidan chiqish mahorati bor

≈ **be a natural at** — tug‘ma qobiliyatli bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: have a gift for + noun / V-ing shaklida ishlatiladi. Part 2 da ustozning mahoratini aytishda foydali; ‘talent’ dan ko‘ra tabiiyroq.

Namuna gap: My uncle **has a gift for** teaching, which is why every child in the street asks him for help.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 spark an interest in

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga qiziqish uyg‘otmoq • *to make someone start to feel curious about something*

BAND 8 STORY
One experiment with a lemon battery **sparked** my **interest in** science. I went home, tried it with a potato, and I was hooked within a week.

≈ **trigger a passion for** — ... ga ishtiyoq uyg‘otmoq

≈ **awaken a curiosity about** — ... ga qiziquvchanlik uyg‘otmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(fe’l) tortishuv yoki mojaroni boshlab yubormoq — The new rule **sparked** a heated debate among parents.

Qachon ishlatiladi: spark + (an) interest in + ot. Part 2 da ‘why you admired’ yoki ‘what they taught’ uchun ishlating; ‘make me like’ dan ancha kuchli.

Namuna gap: A single inspiring lesson can **spark an interest in** a subject that lasts a lifetime.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 make a lasting impression

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uzoq yodda qoladigan taassurot qoldirmoq • *to have an effect that people remember for a long time*

BAND 8 STORY
My first English teacher **made a lasting impression** on me by greeting every student by name. I was only nine, but that small gesture made me feel important, and I still do the same for others today.

≈ **leave a deep impression** — chuqur iz qoldirmoq

≈ **stay with me** — yodimda saqlanib qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Shaxs yoki voqea haqida gapirganda: make a lasting impression on + somebody. Part 2 ning oxirgi qismi uchun ayniqsa mos.

Namuna gap: Her kindness **made a lasting impression** on everyone in our class.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 look up to

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

hurmat qilmoq, ibrat deb bilmoq • *to respect and admire someone*

BAND 8 STORY
I **looked up to** my chemistry teacher because he never gave up on slow learners. Whenever I felt like quitting, I’d remember his patience and try one more time.

≈ **admire** — qoyil qolmoq

≈ **hold in high regard** — yuqori hurmat qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(fe’l) so‘zni lug‘atdan qidirmoq (look up) — I **looked up** the word in a dictionary.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Fe’l iborasi: look up to + kishi (look down on ning teskarisi). Part 1 va 2 da ‘admire’ o‘rniga ishlating.

Namuna gap: Most teenagers **look up to** someone, and quite often it’s a teacher.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 approachable

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

muloqotga ochiq, yaqinlashish oson • *friendly and easy to talk to*

BAND 8 STORY

What I liked most was that she was so **approachable**. If you didn't understand something, you could knock on the staff-room door at any time, and she'd never make you feel stupid for asking.

≈ **easy to talk to** — gaplashish oson

≈ **down-to-earth** — oddiy, kamtar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sifat sifatida ishlatiladi: a very approachable teacher / manager. 'Friendly' dan professionalroq eshitiladi, Part 2 va 3 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Students learn faster when the teacher is **approachable** and not frightening.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 pick up

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'rganib olmoq (tasodifan) • *to learn a skill or habit without formal study*

BAND 8 STORY
I **picked up** most of my English from songs and films, not from textbooks. By fifteen I could follow a whole movie without subtitles, which surprised even my teacher.

≈ **get the hang of** — uddasidan chiqa boshlamoq

≈ **absorb** — singdirib olmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) biror kishi yoki narsani olib ketmoq — I'll **pick** you **up** after school at four.

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) to'xtagan joydan davom ettirmoq — Let's **pick up** where we left off yesterday.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy o'rganishni ta'riflashda: pick up + skill / language. Part 1 da 'How did you learn...?' savollariga mos.
Namuna gap: Children **pick up** languages much faster than adults do.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 get the hang of

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ustasi bo'lib bormoq, ko'nikib olmoq • *to slowly learn how to do something*

BAND 8 STORY
Long division confused me for weeks. Then my teacher showed me a colourful chart, and suddenly I **got the hang of** it and finished the whole worksheet in ten minutes.

≈ **get to grips with** — (biror narsani) tushuna boshlamoq

≈ **master** — puxta egallamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy; yangi ko'nikmani o'rgana boshlaganda: get the hang of + noun / V-ing. Part 1 va 2 da tabiiy.
Namuna gap: It took me a month to **get the hang of** academic writing.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 learn by heart

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

yod olmoq • *to memorise something completely*

BAND 8 STORY
In primary school we had to **learn** long poems **by heart** and recite them in front of everyone. I hated it then, but today I'm grateful, because those lines still pop into my head.

≈ **memorise** — yodlamoq

≈ **commit to memory** — xotiraga muhrlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: She'r, qoida yoki so'zlarni yodlashda: learn sth by heart. Part 3 da rote learning muhokamasida ishlating.
Namuna gap: We were expected to **learn** the multiplication table **by heart**.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 brush up on

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yangilab olmoq, esga solmoq • *to improve a skill you have not used for a while*

BAND 8 STORY
Before my interview, I **brushed up on** my maths for a whole weekend. It was surprising how quickly the old formulas came back once I started practising.

≈ **refresh my memory of** — xotirani yangilamoq

≈ **revise** — takrorlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: brush up on + skill / subject. Allaqachon bilgan narsani qayta mustahkamlashda ishlating; Part 1 uchun yaxshi.
Namuna gap: I'm trying to **brush up on** my French before the trip to Paris.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 cram for an exam

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

imtihonga shosha-pisha tayyorlanmoq • *to study a lot in a short time before a test*

BAND 8 STORY
I **crammed for** my final exam the night before, drinking endless cups of tea. I passed, but I forgot almost everything by the next week, so I never did it again.

≈ **revise at the last minute** — oxirgi daqiqada takrorlamoq

≈ **burn the midnight oil** — tunni bedor o'tkazib o'qimoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) bir joyga siqib joylamoq — They **crammed** ten people into a tiny minibus.

Qachon ishlatiladi: cram for + exam. Odatda salbiy ma'noda ishlatiladi; Part 3 da o'qishning samarasiz usuli sifatida aytsa bo'ladi.
Namuna gap: Students who **cram for** exams rarely remember the material later.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 keep up with

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

(o'qishda) ortda qolmaslik • *to stay at the same level as others*

BAND 8 STORY
In the first year at university I struggled to **keep up with** the reading list. I had to give up weekends for a while, but eventually I found a rhythm that worked.

≈ **stay on top of** — hammasini nazoratda ushlamoq

≈ **stay level with** — bir xil darajada bo'lmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) xabardor bo'lib turmoq, kuzatib bormoq — I try to **keep up with** the news every morning.

Qachon ishlatiladi: keep up with + class / the pace / the workload. Part 2 da qiyinchilikni tasvirlashda yaxshi; teskarisi: fall behind.
Namuna gap: Some pupils find it hard to **keep up with** the rest of the class.
SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 fall behind

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ortda qolib ketmoq • *to fail to keep the same pace as others*

BAND 8 STORY
After a month of illness I **fell behind** in every subject. My teacher gave me extra worksheets and a study plan, and by spring I'd caught up with everyone else.

≈ **lag behind** — orqada qolmoq

≈ **get left behind** — ortda qolib ketmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) to'lovni o'z vaqtida qilolmay qolmoq — He **fell behind** with the rent after losing his job.

Qachon ishlatiladi: fall behind (with / in) + subject. Part 3 da 'weak students' mavzusida foydali; catch up bilan birga ishlating.

Namuna gap: Without regular practice, it's easy to **fall behind** in a foreign language.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 sit an exam

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

imtihon topshirmoq • *to take a test (British English)*

BAND 8 STORY
I **sat** my IELTS **exam** in Tashkent on a freezing January morning. I was shaking from nerves, but once the speaking test began, my preparation took over and I felt strangely calm.

≈ **take an exam** — imtihon topshirmoq

≈ **go in for an exam** — imtihonga kirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: British English: sit an exam (take ham to'g'ri). Hech qachon 'give an exam' demang: bu xato. Part 1 va 2 da ishlating.

Namuna gap: I'll **sit** the final **exam** in June, so I'm revising every evening.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 hand in

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

topshirmoq (uy vazifa, ish) • *to give your finished work to a teacher*

BAND 8 STORY
I stayed up until two a.m. to finish my essay and **hand** it **in** on time. The next morning I could barely keep my eyes open, but I felt proud of myself.

≈ **submit** — topshirmoq

≈ **turn in** — topshirmoq (Amerika)

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) iste'foga chiqqanini rasman bildirmoq — She **handed in** her notice last Friday.

Qachon ishlatiladi: hand in + homework / essay / assignment. 'Submit' rasmiyroq; og'zaki nutqda hand in tabiiy. Part 1 uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: I always **hand in** my assignments a day early to avoid the stress.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 pass with flying colours

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

a’lo natija bilan topshirmoq • *to succeed in a test with a very high score*

BAND 8 STORY

My sister practised for months and **passed** her driving test **with flying colours**. When she came out of the car smiling, the whole family cheered in the street.

≈ **do brilliantly in** — a’lo natija ko‘rsatmoq

≈ **ace** — a’lo topshirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idioma: pass an exam / test with flying colours. Muvaffaqiyatni ta’riflashda ishlating; Part 2 va 3 da kuchli ko‘rinadi.

Namuna gap: He **passed** the entrance exam **with flying colours** and got a scholarship.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Impact and feelings (Part 2 reasons)

COLLOCATIONS 3 / 5

21 have a profound influence on

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga chuqur ta'sir ko'rsatmoq • *to change someone's thinking or life in a big way*

BAND 8 STORY

My literature teacher **had a profound influence on** the way I see the world. After her lessons I started reading novels at night and asking questions about everything around me.

≈ **have a huge impact on** — katta ta'sir qilmoq

≈ **shape the way I think** — fikrlash tarzimni shakllantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: have an influence on + kishi. 'Profound' formal; Part 2 ning 'why admire' qismida kuchli. 'Make influence' demang, xato.

Namuna gap: Good teachers **have a profound influence on** the choices students make later.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 boost my confidence

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishonchimni oshirmoq • *to make me feel more sure of myself*

BAND 8 STORY

When my teacher praised my first speech in front of everyone, it really **boosted my confidence**. I'd never thought I could speak in public, but that day changed my mind.

≈ **build up my self-esteem** — o'zimga bo'lgan hurmatni oshirmoq

≈ **give me a lift** — ruhimni ko'tarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: boost + (my) confidence / self-esteem. Maqtov yoki muvaffaqiyat natijasini aytishda; Part 2 va 3 da keng ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Positive feedback can **boost** a shy child's **confidence** enormously.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 bring out the best in

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

eng yaxshi tomonini ochmoq • *to help someone show their best qualities*

BAND 8 STORY

Mr Aziz had a way of **bringing out the best in** every student. Even the quiet boy at the back began to share his ideas, and that was a lovely thing to watch.

≈ **get the best out of** — eng yaxshisini chiqarmoq

≈ **unlock the potential of** — imkoniyatini ochmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: bring out the best in + kishi. Ustoz yoki murabbiyni maqtashda juda tabiiy; Part 2 da reason sifatida ishlating.

Namuna gap: A caring environment **brings out the best in** children.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 instil a love of

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... ga muhabbat singdirmoq • *to make someone slowly develop a strong liking for something*

BAND 8 STORY

Our primary teacher **instilled a love of** reading in all of us by reading aloud every Friday. Years later, I still choose a book over a film on a rainy day.

≈ **foster a passion for** — ... ga ishtiyoqni o'stirmoq

≈ **nurture an interest in** — qiziqishni parvarishlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: instil a love of + noun / V-ing. Formal, Part 3 da 'role of teachers / parents' haqida gapirganda juda foydali.

Namuna gap: Parents should **instil a love of** learning from an early age.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 open my eyes to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko'zimni ochmoq • *to make me notice or understand something new*

BAND 8 STORY

That trip with my art teacher **opened my eyes to** how much beauty there is in ordinary things. I started noticing patterns on old doors in Bukhara that I'd walked past all my life.

≈ **make me aware of** — xabardor qilmoq

≈ **show me a new side of** — yangi tomonini ko'rsatmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: open sb's eyes to + noun. Yangi tushuncha berganini aytishda ishlating; Part 2 da hikoyani chuqurlashtiradi.

Namuna gap: Studying abroad **opened my eyes to** how differently people think.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 push me out of my comfort zone

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qulaylik doiramdan chiqishga undamoq • *to make me try things I find difficult or scary*

BAND 8 STORY

My coach **pushed me out of my comfort zone** by making me lead the team talk. I was terrified, but afterwards I realised I'd grown more in one week than in a year.

≈ **challenge me** — menga sinov bermoq

≈ **stretch me** — imkoniyatimni kengaytirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: push / step out of one's comfort zone. Rivojlanish haqida hikoya qilganda ishlating; Part 3 da 'challenges' mavzusida ham mos.

Namuna gap: Good teachers **push** students **out of their comfort zone** without crushing them.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 shape my outlook

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

dunyoqarashimni shakllantirmoq • *to form the way I think about life*

BAND 8 STORY

Those years in a small village school really **shaped my outlook**. We had few resources, so we learned to share, to be patient and to value every single book.

≈ **mould my character** — xarakterimni shakllantirmoq

≈ **form my views** — qarashlarimni shakllantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: shape + (my) outlook / personality / character. Formal; Part 2 oxirida va Part 3 da tarbiya mavzusida ishlating.

Namuna gap: School **shapes** a child's **outlook** far more than parents often realise.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 be forever grateful

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

abadiy minnatdor bo'lmoq • *to feel thankful for a very long time*

BAND 8 STORY

I'll **be forever grateful** to my teacher for believing in me when others didn't. Without her, I might have quit school at sixteen and never discovered my love of languages.

≈ **owe a great deal to** — ... ga juda qarzdor bo'lmoq

≈ **can't thank her enough** — rahmat aytib adosiz bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: be forever grateful to + kishi (for + noun / V-ing). His-tuyg'uni kuchli ifodalaydi; Part 2 wrap-up uchun ideal.

Namuna gap: I'll **be forever grateful** to the people who guided me.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 nurture talent

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

iste'dodni parvarishlamoq • *to help a natural ability grow and develop*

BAND 8 STORY

Our school was good at **nurturing talent**: there was a choir, a chess club and even a small theatre. As a result, many of my classmates went on to study music or the arts.

≈ **develop potential** — imkoniyatni rivojlantirmoq

≈ **encourage creativity** — ijodkorlikni rag'batlantirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: nurture + talent / potential / creativity. Part 3 da maktab va davlat roli haqida gapirganda juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Schools need to **nurture talent** instead of just testing it.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 turn things around

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

vaziyatni o‘zgartirmoq • *to change a bad situation into a better one*

BAND 8 STORY

I was failing physics, but my teacher helped me **turn things around** with a simple weekly plan. By the end of the year I was actually enjoying the subject, which still amazes me.

≈ **get back on track** — izga tushib olmoq

≈ **change course** — yo‘nalishni o‘zgartirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) biznes yoki jamoani izga solmoq — The new manager **turned** the failing café **around** in a year.

Qachon ishlatiladi: turn things around: yomon holatdan chiqishni tasvirlaydi. Part 2 da muvaffaqiyat hikoyasi uchun va Part 3 da tuzatish haqida mos.

Namuna gap: A single mentor can help a failing student **turn things around**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

31 a well-rounded education

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

har tomonlama ta'lim • *learning that covers many areas, not only exams*

BAND 8 STORY
A **well-rounded education** should include sport, music and community work as well as maths. My cousin's school in Samarkand offers all of these, and honestly, its graduates seem calmer and more confident than most.

≈ **a balanced education** — muvozanatli ta'lim

≈ **a broad education** — keng qamrovli ta'lim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da ta'lim tizimini muhokama qilganda: provide / receive a well-rounded education. Formal va kuchli, 'good education' dan yaxshiroq.

Namuna gap: Schools should provide **a well-rounded education**, not just exam practice.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 rote learning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yodlashga asoslangan ta'lim • *learning by repeating facts without understanding*

BAND 8 STORY
In my school **rote learning** was everywhere, and we memorised dates without knowing why they mattered. Later at university, I had to relearn how to think for myself, which took ages.

≈ **learning parrot-fashion** — to'tiqush kabi yodlash

≈ **memorisation** — yodlash

Qachon ishlatiladi: Salbiy ma'noda: rely on / be based on rote learning. Part 3 da an'anaviy ta'limni tanqid qilganda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Many experts criticise **rote learning** for killing curiosity.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 critical thinking skills

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

tanqidiy fikrlash ko'nikmalari • *the ability to analyse information and form your own judgement*

BAND 8 STORY
In the modern world, **critical thinking skills** matter more than facts, because facts are one click away. Students who can question a source are far less likely to be fooled by fake news.

≈ **analytical skills** — tahliliy ko'nikmalar

≈ **problem-solving skills** — muammolarni yechish ko'nikmalari

Qachon ishlatiladi: develop / foster / improve + critical thinking skills. Part 3 da maktabning maqsadi haqida gapirganda eng ko'p ishlatiladigan iboralardan biri.

Namuna gap: Schools should **develop critical thinking skills** from an early age.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 tuition fees

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘qish to‘lovi • *money paid for teaching at a university or school*

BAND 8 STORY

In my country, **tuition fees** are a huge burden for many families. My neighbour sold his car just to pay for his daughter’s first year, and she works at weekends to help him.

≈ **course costs** — kurs xarajatlari

≈ **education costs** — ta‘lim xarajatlari

Qachon ishlatiladi: Universitet to‘lovi: pay / afford / cover tuition fees. ‘Tuition’ o‘qitish to‘lovi, ‘fee’ esa umumiy. Part 3 da arzon ta’lim haqida mos.

Namuna gap: Rising **tuition fees** put higher education out of reach for some.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 a one-size-fits-all approach

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

hamma uchun bir xil yondashuv • *a method that treats every person the same*

BAND 8 STORY

A **one-size-fits-all approach** simply doesn’t work in a mixed-ability class. Some pupils are bored in ten minutes, while others are still lost, and the teacher can’t help both.

≈ **a blanket policy** — hammaga bir xil siyosat

≈ **a uniform method** — bir xil usul

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odatda inkor bilan: ‘is not a one-size-fits-all’. Part 3 da yagona dastur yoki sinov tanqid qilinganda foydali.

Namuna gap: Education cannot rely on **a one-size-fits-all approach**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 equip students with

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘quvchilarni ... bilan qurollantirmoq • *to give learners the skills they need*

BAND 8 STORY

Good schools **equip students with** practical skills, like teamwork and time management. When my brother started his first job, those were exactly the skills that helped him settle in quickly.

≈ **provide students with** — o‘quvchilarga ... bermoq

≈ **prepare students for** — o‘quvchilarni ... ga tayyorlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: equip + kishi + with + skills / tools / knowledge. Part 3 da ta’lim va ish haqidagi savollarda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Schools must **equip students with** skills for the future job market.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 bridge the gap between

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

… orasidagi tafovutni yo‘qotmoq • *to reduce the difference between two things*

BAND 8 STORY

Internships can **bridge the gap between** theory and practice. When I worked in a local clinic for a summer, I finally understood what my textbooks had been describing for two years.

≈ **close the gap between** — orasidagi farqni yopmoq

≈ **link theory with practice** — nazariyani amaliyot bilan bog‘lamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: bridge the gap between A and B. Part 3 da universitet va ish haqida; juda keng ishlatiladi, ayniqsa ‘theory and practice’.

Namuna gap: Work placements help **bridge the gap between** study and employment.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 lifelong learning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

umr bo‘yi o‘rganish • *the idea of studying new things throughout your whole life*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandfather is a great example of **lifelong learning**: at seventy he joined a computer course for beginners. He says that being curious keeps his mind young, and I think he’s right.

≈ **continuous learning** — uzluksiz o‘rganish

≈ **continuing education** — davomli ta’lim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da ‘ta’lim maktabdan keyin ham davom etadi’ deganda: promote / embrace lifelong learning. Bu ibora argumentni boyitadi.

Namuna gap: In a fast-changing world, **lifelong learning** is no longer optional.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 access to quality education

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

sifatli ta’limga erishish imkoniyati • *the chance to study in good schools with good teachers*

BAND 8 STORY

Access to quality education shouldn’t depend on where a child is born. In remote villages, kids often walk for an hour to a school with no heating, and that’s simply unfair.

≈ **equal opportunities in education** — ta’limda teng imkoniyatlar

≈ **educational inequality** — ta’limdagi tengsizlik

Qachon ishlatiladi: have / provide / improve access to + noun. Part 3 da ijtimoiy adolat va hukumat roli haqida ishlating.

Namuna gap: Governments should guarantee **access to quality education** for every child.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 student-centred learning

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

o‘quvchiga yo‘naltirilgan ta’lim • *teaching that focuses on what learners need and prefer*

BAND 8 STORY

My university used **student-centred learning**: we chose project topics and presented them to each other. It was harder than listening to lectures, but I remember far more from those projects.

≈ **a hands-on approach** — amaliy yondashuv

≈ **interactive teaching** — interaktiv o‘qitish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zamonaviy ta’lim usullarini tasvirlashda: adopt / favour student-centred learning. Part 3 da an’anaviy usul bilan solishtirganda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Student-centred learning** encourages pupils to take responsibility for their progress.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

41 distance learning

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

masofaviy ta’lim • *studying at home with courses sent online or by post*

BAND 8 STORY

During the pandemic, **distance learning** became normal overnight. I remember my little sister sitting on the carpet with a tablet, trying to concentrate while the whole family walked past.

≈ **remote learning** — masofadan o‘qish

≈ **online schooling** — onlayn maktab

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pandemiya va texnologiya haqida: take part in / switch to distance learning. Part 3 da ‘technology and teachers’ savollarida kerak bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: **Distance learning** gives flexibility but it demands a lot of self-discipline.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 a steep learning curve

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

dastlab qiyin o‘rganish jarayoni • *a situation where you must learn a lot very quickly*

BAND 8 STORY

Starting a degree in English was **a steep learning curve** for me. I had to read academic articles every night, but after three months, it started to feel almost normal.

≈ **a baptism of fire** — qiyin sinov

≈ **a challenging start** — qiyin boshlanish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi narsaga qiyin kirishishni aytishda: be / face a steep learning curve. Part 2 da qiyinchilik hikoyasi uchun ajoyib.

Namuna gap: Moving abroad was **a steep learning curve**, but it made me stronger.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 broaden one’s horizons

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

dunyoqarashni kengaytirmoq • *to experience new things and widen your knowledge*

BAND 8 STORY

Studying abroad would **broaden my horizons** because I’d meet people who think differently. Even a short exchange programme could change how I see my own country.

≈ **expand my worldview** — dunyoqarashimni kengaytirmoq

≈ **see the bigger picture** — kengroq ko‘rmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: broaden + (my) horizons. Chet elda o‘qish haqidagi Part 1 savoliga javobda juda yaxshi; Part 3 da sayohat bilan ham mos.

Namuna gap: Travelling and studying abroad both **broaden** young people’s **horizons**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 immerse oneself in

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini ... ga to‘liq bag‘ishlamoq • *to become completely involved in something*

BAND 8 STORY

The best way to learn a language is to **immerse yourself in** the culture. When I lived with a host family in London for a month, I was dreaming in English by the end.

≈ **throw myself into** — o‘zimni to‘liq bag‘ishlamoq

≈ **get absorbed in** — ishtiyoq bilan sho‘ng‘imoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: immerse oneself in + culture / language / book. Chet elda o‘qish yoki til o‘rganish haqida ishlating; Part 1 va 3 uchun mos.

Namuna gap: I’d love to **immerse myself in** a new culture for a year.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 academic performance

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

akademik ko‘rsatkich • *how well a student does in studies and exams*

BAND 8 STORY

My **academic performance** improved dramatically once I started getting eight hours of sleep. It sounds simple, but my marks went up in every subject within a term.

≈ **school results** — maktab natijalari

≈ **educational achievement** — ta’limdagi yutuqlar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Formal ibora: improve / affect academic performance. Part 3 da stress, texnologiya yoki uyqu ta’siri haqida gapirganda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Excessive screen time can harm children’s **academic performance**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 peer pressure

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tengdoshlar bosimi • *the influence of people your own age to behave like them*

BAND 8 STORY

Peer pressure is very real in secondary school. I remember wanting expensive trainers just because everyone else had them, and I felt guilty asking my parents for money.

≈ **social pressure** — ijtimoiy bosim

≈ **fitting in** — jamoaga moslashish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da o‘smirlar haqida: succumb to / resist / be under peer pressure. Tabiiy va muhokamada tez-tez uchraydi.

Namuna gap: Teenagers often give in to **peer pressure** without thinking.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 extracurricular activities

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

darsdan tashqari mashg‘ulotlar • *clubs and hobbies done outside lessons*

BAND 8 STORY

I took part in several **extracurricular activities**, including chess and the school newspaper. They taught me teamwork and made school feel like a community instead of just a place to sit exams.

≈ **after-school clubs** — darsdan keyingi to‘garaklar

≈ **school clubs** — maktab to‘garaklari

Qachon ishlatiladi: take part in / join + extracurricular activities. Part 1 va 3 da maktab hayotini tasvirlashda ishlating.

Namuna gap: **Extracurricular activities** help students develop social skills.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 hands-on experience

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

amaliy tajriba • *practical learning by doing the real activity*

BAND 8 STORY

Nothing beats **hands-on experience**. During my placement at a bakery, I learned more about teamwork and pressure in two weeks than in a full semester of lectures.

≈ **practical experience** — amaliy tajriba

≈ **real-world experience** — hayotiy tajriba

Qachon ishlatiladi: gain / get hands-on experience. Part 3 da amaliyot va nazariya haqida yoki Part 2 da o‘rganish hikoyasida ishlating.

Namuna gap: Employers value **hands-on experience** as much as qualifications.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 drop out of school

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

maktabni tashlab ketmoq • *to leave school before finishing*

BAND 8 STORY

One of my classmates **dropped out of school** at fifteen to help his father at the bazaar. Years later, he took evening classes and finished, which I find truly inspiring.

≈ **quit school** — maktabni tark etmoq

≈ **leave without qualifications** — diplomsiz ketmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) guruh yoki tadbirni tashlab ketmoq — She had to **drop out of** the competition because of an injury.

Qachon ishlatiladi: drop out of + school / college / a course. Part 3 da sabablari va muammolari haqida gapirganda ishlating; noun: a dropout.

Namuna gap: Poverty is a major reason why some children **drop out of school**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 lay the foundations

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

poydevor qo‘ymoq • *to create the basic knowledge needed for later learning*

BAND 8 STORY

Primary school **lays the foundations** for everything that comes later. If a child learns to read well by eight, they usually find every other subject easier.

≈ **lay the groundwork** — asos yaratmoq

≈ **build a solid base** — mustahkam asos yaratmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: lay + the foundations for + noun. Part 3 da erta bolalik ta’limi haqida; ‘basic’ o‘rniga yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Early years **lay the foundations** for a child’s whole future.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I admired most about X was that...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

X ning menga eng yoqqan jihati shu ediki... • *A cleft sentence that puts the key quality first for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

What I admired most about her **was that** she never raised her voice. She could silence a noisy class of thirty with a single look, and that calm authority impressed me deeply.

≈ **The thing I valued most was...** — Men eng qadrlagan narsa...

≈ **What stood out was...** — Ko'zga tashlangan narsa...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 2 da ustozni maqtashda: What I admired most about + ot + was + that gap yoki ot. Fikrni ta'kidlaydi va gapni boyitadi.

Namuna gap: **What I admired most about** my teacher **was** her endless patience with slow learners.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 not only... but also...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafaqat ... balki ... • *Joins two good points and gives extra weight to the second*

BAND 8 STORY

My teacher **not only** explained the lesson clearly **but also** stayed after class to answer every question. Because of that, even the weakest students started to believe in themselves.

≈ **as well as + V-ing** — ... bilan bir qatorda

≈ **besides V-ing** — ... dan tashqari

Qachon ishlatiladi: not only A but also B: A va B bir xil grammatik shaklda bo'lishi kerak. Part 1 va 2 da ikki afzallikni birlashtirish uchun ishlating.

Namuna gap: The school **not only** taught us facts **but also** showed us how to learn.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 Not only did + S + V, but + S + also + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafaqat ... balki ... ham (inversiya) • *Inverted form after 'Not only' for a strong, formal effect*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only did she teach us grammar, **but** she **also** taught us how to be confident public speakers. By the end of the year, even the shyest girl in class was giving presentations.

≈ **Not only was..., but...** — Nafaqat ... edi, balki ...

≈ **Not just... but...** — Faqatgina emas ... balki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'Not only' gap boshida kelsa, yordamchi fe'l oldin: Not only did she teach... Part 2 da kuchli taassurot uchun ishlating; ortiqcha qilmang.

Namuna gap: **Not only did** school give me knowledge, **but** it **also** gave me lifelong friends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 Having + p.p., S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... qilgach, ... • *A participle clause that shows one action happened before another*

BAND 8 STORY

Having failed my first exam, I decided to change how I studied. I asked my teacher for advice, made a weekly plan, and passed the retake with a good mark.

≈ **After + V-ing, ...** — ... dan keyin ...

≈ **Once I had..., I...** — Qachonki men ... bo'lgach, ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Having + p.p. oldingi harakatni qisqa ifodalaydi; ikkala gapning subyekti bir xil bo'lishi kerak. Part 2 va 3 da hikoya tuzishda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Having spent** years in a crowded classroom, I now appreciate quiet study spaces.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 the teacher + who/whose...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

... o'qituvchi, uning ... • *A relative clause that adds detail about the person*

BAND 8 STORY

I remember the teacher **whose** classes were always full of laughter, and **who** never gave up on anyone. Her kindness is why I decided to become a teacher myself.

≈ **the teacher + that...** — ... o'qituvchi

≈ **the person + who...** — ... odam

Qachon ishlatiladi: Whose = ning; kishi haqida batafsil ma'lumot bering. Part 2 da ustozni tasvirlashda gapni boyitish uchun ishlating.

Namuna gap: She was the kind of teacher **whose** enthusiasm was contagious.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 so + adj + that...

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shu qadar ... ki ... • *Shows a strong result of a quality*

BAND 8 STORY

His explanations were **so** clear **that** even complex formulas felt simple. After a few weeks, I stopped dreading maths and started to look forward to Tuesdays.

≈ **such + a/an + adj + noun + that** — shunday ... ki

≈ **to the point where...** — ... darajada ki ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: so + sifat + that + natija; such + ot bilan. Part 2 da sababni kuchaytirish uchun ishlating. 'Very' ni almashtiradi.

Namuna gap: The lesson was **so** inspiring **that** I wrote about it in my diary.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Had I not met X, I would have...

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar X bilan uchrashmaganimda, ... bo'lardi • *An inverted third conditional for imagining a different past*

BAND 8 STORY

Had I not met my English teacher, I would never have applied for a scholarship. I'd probably still be working in a shop and wondering what might have been.

≈ **If I hadn't met..., I would have...** — Agar uchrashmaganimda ...

≈ **Without her, I would have...** — Usiz, men ... bo'lardim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Had + S + p.p., S + would have + p.p.: formal 'if' ni tushirib qoldiradi. Part 2 oxirida muhim odamning ta'sirini ko'rsatish uchun juda kuchli.

Namuna gap: **Had I not studied** abroad, I wouldn't have discovered my passion for design.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 If it hadn't been for X, I wouldn't have...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar X bo'lmaganida, men ... qilmagan bo'lardim • *A third conditional to give credit to a person or event*

BAND 8 STORY

If it hadn't been for my teacher's encouragement, I wouldn't have entered the debate contest. I was so nervous, but I ended up winning, and it still feels unreal.

≈ **Were it not for...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida

≈ **But for + noun** — ... bo'lmaganida

Qachon ishlatiladi: If it hadn't been for + ot / ot birikmasi, would have + p.p. Minnatdorchilik bildirishda ishlating; Part 2 yakunida yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **If it hadn't been for** my parents' support, I couldn't have gone to university.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 It was X that/who...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

aynan X ... edi • *A cleft that stresses who or what was responsible*

BAND 8 STORY

It was my history teacher **who** first suggested I should study law. I laughed at the time, but a year later, I applied, and now I can't imagine doing anything else.

≈ **It was then that...** — Aynan o'shanda ...

≈ **It was thanks to...** — Aynan ... sabab ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: It was + ta'kidlanayotgan so'z + that / who + qolgan gap. Kimdir yoki nimadir hal qiluvchi bo'lganini aytishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: **It was** at school **that** I first learned to work in a team.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 Little did I know that...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

qayoqdan ham bilardim ki ... • *An inverted phrase for an unexpected result*

BAND 8 STORY

Little did I know that this one lesson would change my career. Years later, when I became a teacher myself, I remembered exactly how her class had made me feel.

≈ **Never had I imagined...** — Hech tasavvur qilmagan edim ...

≈ **I had no idea that...** — Bilmagan edim ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Little did + S + know + that gap: kutilmagan oqibatni ta'kidlaydi. Part 2 hikoyasida burilish uchun ishlating, qisqa va kuchli.

Namuna gap: **Little did I know** that moving to Tashkent would open so many doors.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 The more..., the more...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qanchalik ... bo'lsa, shunchalik ... • *A comparative pair showing two things change together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I practised speaking, **the more** confident I became. Soon I stopped checking my notes and could just chat with my classmates for ten minutes without any fear.

≈ **The harder..., the better...** — Qanchalik qattiq ... shunchalik yaxshi ...

≈ **As + S + V, S + also + V** — ... sari ... ham ...

Qachon ishlatiladi: The + qiyoslash sifati + gap, the + qiyoslash sifati + gap. Part 3 da sabab va natija munosabatini ko'rsatish uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: **The more** time students spend online, **the less** they read.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 I wish / If only + past perfect

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

koshki ... bo'lganda edi • *Expresses regret about a past situation*

BAND 8 STORY

I wish I **had paid** more attention in my school days. Back then I thought music lessons were pointless, but now I'd give anything to play the piano properly.

≈ **If only I had...** — Koshki ... bo'lganimda

≈ **I regret not + V-ing** — ... qilmaganimga afsusdaman

Qachon ishlatiladi: I wish + had + p.p. o'tmishga afsus bildiradi. Part 3 da shaxsiy tajriba va maslahat berishda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **If only** I **had started** learning English earlier, I'd be fluent by now.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a teacher you admired.

Describe a teacher you admired.

You should say:

- who the teacher was
- what they taught
- what they were like
- why you admired them

My 1-minute notes

- Ms Dilfuza • English • Grade nine
- grammar • stories • songs
- patient • cheerful • never shouted
- stayed after class • extra mile
- boosted confidence • public speaking
- forever grateful • career choice

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (who)	I'd like to talk about my English teacher, Ms Dilfuza, who taught me in Grade nine at a state school in Tashkent. She's the person I look up to most in my education, and I still remember her classroom perfectly.
P • What they taught	As for the subject, she taught us English, but she did far more than explain grammar. She had a gift for bringing a dull rule to life with songs, funny stories and little role-plays, so we were always engaged.
P • What they were like	When it comes to her personality, she was warm, patient and strict but fair. She never raised her voice, yet the whole class listened. She also went the extra mile, staying after school to help anyone who was falling behind.
E • Reason 1	The first reason I admired her is that she boosted my confidence. I was a very shy boy, and when she praised my first short speech, something changed in me. What I appreciated most was that she pushed me out of my comfort zone, gently.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, she sparked my interest in languages. Had I not met her, I would never have applied for a degree in English, and I'd probably be doing a completely different job today.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, Ms Dilfuza made a lasting impression on me, both as a teacher and as a human being. I'll be forever grateful to her, and I try to treat other people with the same patience she showed me.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
a good teacher	an inspiring, approachable teacher
helped me a lot	went the extra mile for me
I liked the lesson	the lesson really brought the subject to life
I learned a lot	I picked up so much from her
she was strict	she was strict but fair
it changed me	it had a profound influence on me
I'm thankful	I'll be forever grateful
she made students interested	she kept students engaged
an example to follow	a role model
she is good at teaching	she has a gift for teaching
she made me like science	she sparked an interest in science
learning without understanding	rote learning
learn it from memory	learn it by heart
study again quickly	brush up on
study at the last minute	cram for an exam
stay at the same level as others	keep up with the class
stay behind others	fall behind
take an exam	sit an exam
give in homework	hand in homework
very good marks	pass with flying colours
made me more confident	boosted my confidence
show the best of me	bring out the best in me
teach me to love books	instil a love of reading
think like a critic	critical thinking skills
school fees	tuition fees